Adventure Ardeche

Staff Handbook

Matt Thompson, Adventure Ardeche

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1. Staff Handbook

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> **Info**
>
> A way to evangelize, explain, and support solutions to peers so they can be correctly used and successfully adopted

Supporting **Learning Objectives** & **Efficiency** to create **High Quality Provision** & making learning outdoors accessible to all.

1.0.1 EMPOWER YOUNG PEOPLE TO THRIVE

Immersion in the outdoors builds core skills for their future.

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2. Overview

This online document is essentially a **HANDBOOK** to guide you through the systems in place at **Adventure Ardeche**.

> **Tip**
>
> Those systems are laid out in the menu on the left in order of need.

The handbook is provided so that staff have a easily accessible reference to the informations, systems, other resources etc to hand. It is also available as a paper based resource in the Centre Managers office and Activity Managers office. You can also load as a **.pdf** by clicking the icon in the top right of the browser window.

The handbook is designed so that whenever a staff member is unsure of their requirements they can firstly refer to the handbook, before then approaching either the Activity Manager or Centre Manager for further clarification of their query.

The information contained here is under a continual process of updating and development. **Critical Information** ie. *Risk Assessments* or *Policies & Procedures* are reviewed yearly or after an incident.

> **Warning**
>
> Critical Information should not change, and if it does, staff will be informed through the **staff meeting** channel.

Your contribution is essential to expanding, simplifing, and editing the information contained here. Please feel free to suggest any changes, amendments, or additions to either the Activity Manager or Centre Manager or one of the **Leadership Team**.

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3. Expectations

3.1 Staff Expectations

The ability to introduce, present, instruct and enthuse about the subject or activity you are employed for.

An up-to-date knowledge of all safety and technical aspects of the subject or activity for which you are employed.

The ability to effectively manage the activity for which you are employed, and to deal effectively with all worst-case scenarios that you might encounter during the activity, hence all instructors must make available use of all appropriate safety equipment and familiarise themselves with respective emergency procedures.

The ability to enable, motivate and support each and every individual customer.

We do not expect staff to run "**standard**" activities

If one individual needs greater attention than another, we expect that it be provided with skill and without prejudice in order that that individual gains as much as they desire, rather than being required to conform to "**normal**" requirements.

> **Note**
>
> We expect that staff will go out of their way for our customers! A polite, courteous and supportive approach to all customers, members of the public and fellow staff members.

- That the Leadership Team is informed about any personal issue that may affect the quality of any aspect of your operation:
- Such information should be given openly, and at the earliest possible opportunity.
- We would expect that staff will go out of their way to ensure that this happens.
- An up-to-date knowledge and awareness of legal responsibilities, Health and Safety issues, PPE regulations, and risk assessment requirements.
- That **all** accidents, incidents and near misses are reported and recorded.
- That **all** first aid treatments are reported.
- That any information about guests that might be required prior to medical treatment, is obtained, recorded, and passed on to others **only** on a need to know basis, in confidence, and at the earliest opportunity.
- That any questions regarding Health and Safety, guest care, professional duty, and any other matter between guest(s), and Adventure Ardeche personnel are referred to the Leadership Team at the earliest opportunity.

3.1.1 Code of Practice

For the safety and wellbeing of those involved in any activity, during an Adventure Ardeche experience.

> **Info**
>
> The purpose of this code is to state the practice that should be in use during any activity in relation to organisational, safety, and the physical well-being of everyone concerned.

3.1.2 This code will be successfully operational when:

- A good working relationship and clear communication exists between the staff running the activity, their guests, and the Leadership Team.

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- We (*all staff involved*) carefully plan and prepare all activities and identify special and particular needs as early as practicable
- We clearly define objectives for the activity, relating to the age group and type of our guests, and clearly identify the overall aims of each guest and guest group
- Each instructor, or facilitator is competent to deliver the activity for which they have been employed
- Our resources and facilities are well managed.
- Adventure Ardeche staff must always be prepared to adapt, and to be flexible in their outlook, and in their management of resources to ensure that we create a safe and enjoyable experience for all the guests who have placed their trust in our organisation.
- The information contained in this document is intended to be guidance for all people working within Adventure Ardeche. It is expected that all people working within Adventure Ardeche read, digest and use this information, and where they recognise that improvements could be made, they take it upon themselves to inform the Leadership Team.
- We support the development of and interaction between staff and the Leadership Team with the intention of improving the odds against unsafe operation in hazardous situations.
- We foresee that any staff member may opt to take actions that fall outside the scope of this document in order to maintain a safe environment, and where there is sufficient evidence to suggest that their course of action is justified, we will support them.
- Each staff member will make judgements according to their own training and experiences, and we support those decisions that are taken in order to create a safe working environment and to reduce the risk to health in any given situation.
- Adventure Ardeche policies and procedures are published for guidance and we recognise that qualified and experienced staff will use their expertise to design appropriate solutions for different situations, locations and guest types.
- The nature of our business is such that the aims and objectives of our guests may be to increase the risks that they take. Our policy is to ensure that these risks are reduced to a reasonable level and that the guest is fully aware of the hazards and the consequences.
- We will always support a guest in achieving their objectives as safely as possible, and will advise and instruct a guest in support of his or her objectives. Where a guests' objectives and intentions are not conducive to a safe and positive outcome we will advise against their actions and prevent them from proceeding where appropriate.
- We expect that the standard and practises specified by the National Governing Bodies are, on the whole, adopted as a basic minimum standard for the relevant activities, and where no specification has been made, that the staff involved discuss their intended safe operating practises with the Leadership Team or persons notified by them (*Technical Advisors*).

3.1.3 How to look after clients

What we expect, what the guest can expect, what legal responsibilities we have and what should not be done!

Note

Adventure Ardeche is not intended to be an organisation that offers poor or even average standards of service. We expect that all staff working within Adventure Ardeche perform to an excellent standard, which is clearly obvious to all.

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The following criteria are laid down as the result of feedback from past guests who have found our service to be excellent.

Our guests can expect the following from all personnel:

- High standards of personal presentation.
- Exceptional punctuality.
- Attention to detail.
- A focus on the guest experience at all times.
- Polite, courteous and proactively helpful behaviour.
- Open, honest communication.
- High standards of technical skill.
- Clear and appropriate instruction.
- Safe practice.
- An enabling, inspiring and enjoyable experience.

3.1.4 Standard Staff Practices

We expect that a staff member carries out the following regardless of the activity they are undertaking. These guidelines are offered as a check for all staff– we recognise that different methods may be used to achieve these results.

- Get one or more appropriate weather forecasts.
- Gather up to date information about your guests (medical, fitness, behavioural and dietary) from the Leadership Team or directly from the participants.
- Ensure that your Leadership Team knows your intended route or activity site, ETA and party details.
- Ensure that you have any activity appropriate kit with you.
- Identify yourself to the group, introduce yourself by name, and ensure that all accompanying adults are aware of your role.
- Clearly identify the role you want any accompanying adults to take, even if it is a passive role.
- Ensure that each client is appropriately dressed and equipped for the activity.
- Carry, and know how to use appropriate 1st Aid, safety and rescue equipment.
- Provide a clear overview and briefing for all activities and re-brief whenever the activity changes.
- Learn the first names of all of your guests.
- Watch for individuals struggling and provide additional help and encouragement.
- Provide clear warnings in advance of any significant hazard followed by appropriate instruction and equipment as required.
- Record any incidents or accidents in the appropriate place and notify the Leadership Team

3.1.5 Standard Instructor Kit

All instructors must ensure the following is available at any time during an activity:

- First aid kit
- Group shelter or large survival bag
- Reliable light source if operating in the evenings
- Any safety or rescue equipment appropriate to the prevailing and anticipated conditions, the nature of the activity and the number, type and ability of guests. This might normally include spare clothing, food/energy source, hydration and an appropriate form of communication.

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3.1.6 Basic Philosophies

Whilst engaging in an activity for the pure element of participation and fun is valuable, many of our guests are at a period of their development where sound role-modelling and example is of great benefit to them. As an Instructor at Adventure Ardeche you are in an enviable position where the example you set is a foundational block in a guests life journey, use that position/opportunity with clear thought.

Learning Through Experience

- Engaging Experiences
- Promote Skill Mastery
- Incorporate Reflection
- Learn from both Success & Failure

Challenge & Adventure

- Through Unfamiliar Settings
- Through activities that are Mentally & Physically Challenging
- Guests have '*More in them than they know*'

Supportive Environment

- Provide both Physical and Emotional Safety
- Be a Skilled & Compassionate Instructor
- Foster a Caring, Positive, and Inclusive culture

3.1.7 As a member of Adventure Ardeche staff, live positively…

Physical Fitness

Build physical and emotional stamina to meet challenges.

Craftsmanship

Model quality and intention through your actions.

Self-Reliance

Be resourceful, apply personal strengths.

Compassion

Engage in the welfare and dignity of others.

What people have the capacity to choose, they have the abilities to change.
Madeleine K Albright

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4. Policies

4.1 Child Protection & Safeguarding

Effective safeguarding systems are child centred. Failings in safeguarding systems are too often the result of losing sight of the needs and views of the children within them, or placing the interests of adults ahead of the needs of children. Children want to be respected, their views to be heard, to have stable relationships with professionals built on trust and for consistent support provided for their individual needs. This should guide the behaviour of professionals.

Anyone working with children should see and speak to the child; listen to what they say; take their views seriously; and work with them collaboratively when deciding how to support their needs.

4.1.1 Children have said that they need:

- **Vigilance:** to have adults notice when things are troubling them;
- **Understanding and action:** to understand what is happening; to be heard and understood; and to have that understanding acted upon;
- **Stability:** to be able to develop an on-going stable relationship of trust with those helping them;
- **Respect:** to be treated with the expectation that they are competent rather than not; Information and engagement: to be informed about and involved in procedures, decisions, concerns and plans;
- **Explanation:** to be informed of the outcome of assessments and decisions and reasons when their views have not met with a positive response;
- **Support:** to be provided with support in their own right as well as a member of their family;
- **Advocacy:** to be provided with advocacy to assist them in putting forward their views.

Effective ongoing action to keep the child in focus also includes:

- Eliciting the child's wishes and feelings - about their situation now as well as plans and hopes for the future;
- Providing children with honest and accurate information about the current situation, as seen by professionals, and future possible actions and interventions;
- Involving the child in key decision-making;
- Providing appropriate information to the child about his or her right to protection and assistance;
- Inviting children to make recommendations about the services and assistance they need and/or are available to them;
- Ensuring children have access to independent advice and support, to be able to express their views, and influence decision-making.

Even initial discussions with children should be conducted in a way that minimises any distress caused to them and maximises the likelihood that they will provide helpful information. Children may need time and more than one opportunity in order to develop sufficient trust to communicate any concerns they may have, especially if they have a communication impairment, learning disabilities, are very young or are experiencing mental health problems.

4.1.2 Policy

- Having zero-tolerance for child abuse.
- Protecting children’s rights and their best interests.
- Placing the child as the first priority when dealing with all identified or suspected cases of child abuse.
- Empowering and educating children on their rights, personal safety and steps they can take, if there is a problem.

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4.1.3 Preventing Abuse

- Physical abuse, Neglect, Emotional abuse, and Sexual abuse
- Training children, staff and volunteers on how to identify and prevent child abuse.
- Giving children the opportunity to participate in programmes that educate them on their rights, personal-safety techniques and steps they can take in case of a problem.
- Encouraging and supporting children, staff and community members to report cases of abuse.
- Allowing all children and teens the opportunity to participate in programmes regardless of gender, sexual orientation, disability, ethnicity or religion
- Integrating child protection into all aspects of our organisational strategy, structures and work practices.

4.1.4 Protocols

- Nominated Person for Child Protection/Safeguarding
- Adhere to Best Practice wherever possible

Best Practice means

- Always working in an open environment (e.g. avoiding private or unobserved situations and encouraging open communication with no secrets).
- Treating all young people/disabled adults with respect and dignity.
- Always putting the welfare of each young person first, before achieving goals or winning.
- Maintaining a safe and appropriate distance (e.g. it is not appropriate for staff or volunteers to have an intimate relationship with a child or to share a room with them).
- Building relationships based on mutual trust, which empowers children to share in the decision-making process.
- Making activities fun, enjoyable and promoting fair play, without prejudice.
- Ensuring that if any form of manual/physical support is required, it should be provided openly and appropriately. Care is needed, as it is difficult to position hands appropriately in certain circumstances. Young people should ideally be consulted and their agreement gained where possible. Some parents are becoming increasingly sensitive about manual support and their views should always be carefully considered.
- Involving parents/carers/teachers whenever appropriate. For example, engaging them to take responsibility for their children in the changing rooms. If groups have to be supervised in the changing rooms, try to ensure that parents, teachers, instructors or volunteers work in pairs.
- Ensuring that where possible, a male and female member of staff should always accompany mixed groups. However, remember that same-gender abuse can also occur.
- Ensuring that during residential events, adults should avoid entering children’s bedrooms and should never invite children into their private rooms.
- Being an excellent role model – this includes not smoking or drinking alcohol in the company of young people. Giving enthusiastic and constructive feedback rather than negative criticism.
- Recognising the developmental needs and capacity of young people with and without disabilities – avoiding excessive physical activity or competition and not pushing them against their will.
- Create and Maintain an Anti-Bullying environment
- Recruit staff safely. Ensure **ALL** relevant checks are made.
- Effective management through Supervision, Support, Training, Monitoring, Quality Assurance.
- Provision of a **Safe Environment** at all times, by applying best practice **Health & Safety** guidance and other legal requirements.
- Manage any allegations appropriately and in a timely manner.

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> **Note**
>
> Staff/volunteers are not trained to deal with situations of abuse or to decide if abuse has occurred.

This document is in place to ensure safeguarding is at the heart of what we do. All staff take part in safeguarding training during their induction.

4.1.5 Resources

United Kingdom

Save The Children - Child Protection Policy PDF

NSPCC Helpline: 0808 800 5000

France

Nominated child protection and safeguarding officer

Name: Ian McInnes

Phone/email: 0033612502021 / ian@adventureardeche.com

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4.2 Risk Mitigation

4.2.1 A Simple Risk Assessment Process

Managing safety through compliance has traditionally been at the forefront of thinking when it comes to safety. However, organisations might approach safety in 2 ways: by paying greater attention to the traditional tools of risk assessments and risk controls, often built upon risk avoidance, risk prevention or repression; or by learning to deploy a broader and more informed perspective of safety, beyond the applying and monitoring of controls, to that of **safety by design**.

A Modern Approach

Understanding safety by design starts instead by investing in **shared values and beliefs**, interacting with our organisation's structures and control systems to produce behavioural norms. That is, how the people and the cultures they develop, support a healthy **safety climate**.

In organised outdoor learning it is common for there to be a residual level of risk that is judged to be tolerable and in balance with the benefits that will accrue.

It is desirable to give equal consideration to risks and benefits throughout the planning process to avoid benefits being eclipsed by a small possibility of harm.

Hazards and risks cannot be considered in isolation; it is necessary to consider the maturity and experience of learners, the expertise of those leading them, wishes of parents and many other factors. En gagement with actual risk is vital if learners are to develop the skills to deal with the succession of risks they will meet in their own lives.

Look, explore, listen, etc - get to know the environment that you are working in, and the potential interaction between you, your participants and that environment. There is no point in assessing a risk without knowledge of the full implications.

Info

We believe young people take strides in their development when negotiating a controlled level of risk through outdoor education.

Risk level = how bad could it be x the chance of it happening

Danger

Rate the worst probable and possible consequence due to that hazard on a scale of 1-5:

- Cause for minor concern e.g. a small graze, helmet rash, a small bruise;
- Minor injuries treatable with a first aid kit but which wouldn't normally require the attention of a medical officer e.g. cuts, twists, scratch
- Injuries or ailments requiring evacuation and medical attention e.g. mild hypothermia, animal bites, an untreatable asthma attack, lacerations requiring stitches, minor breaks.
- Major trauma, epileptic seizure, head injury, major broken bones, significant burns, hypothermia, hyperthermia
- Death, paralysis, dismemberment, high voltage/high current electrocution, freezing.

X

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Likelyhood

Rate the chances of that hazard occurring on a scale of 1-5:

- Almost never – e.g. lightning striking close to your party
- Highly unlikely e.g. the chance of someone letting go of the rope whilst abseiling
- Happening every so often e.g. a serious change in weather
- Likely, if not probable e.g. a pebble falling off the top of an abseil pitch or a child tripping on rough ground
- Certain or almost certain to happen e.g. someone in your party getting tired on a long walk.

=

Outcome

6-8 is acceptable in outdoor activities (Although you may be able to reduce it with concise instruction and warnings).

Danger

8+? You must reduce it

If you identify a hazard and assess the risk to be greater than 8 you are expected to take steps to reduce the risk, which means clearly and concisely identifying the hazard to all people in your party, giving clear, concise instruction, issuing appropriate equipment and (*unless your purpose* is to lead your clients through the hazardous environment*) leading them away from the hazard towards an environment in which the risk is acceptable.

- *If you are contracted to lead clients up an ice climb (as an example), their purpose would be to tackle any hazards encountered including those rated above level 8 because the clients' enjoyment and fulfilment comes from that level of risk acceptance. However, even at this level the instructor should be taking reasonable precautions to ensure the safety of his/her clients - so a risk level 12 may be acceptable.*

Abstract

On occasion, an outdoor learning experience of great value may be judged to be right and proper even if some significant risks cannot be eliminated or significantly reduced. This is not a position to be entered in to lightly and without thought of the possible consequences.

4.2.2 Planning Tool

Risk Assessment Planning Tool

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4.3 Emergency Procedure

Do.!

4.3.1 During the Incident

During an Emergency you will not have time to read this guidance – you will be reliant on training and effective/practised systems.

4.3.2 Immediate Action

Assess the situation, establishing the nature and extent of the problem but ensuring that the leaders do not put themselves or others at further risk.

Make sure all other members of the party are:

- Accounted for.
- Safe.
- Adequately supervised.
- Briefed to ensure that they understand what to do to remain safe. Leaders should assume their allocated roles - ensuring that where one or more of the Visit Leadership Team is incapacitated then these roles are reassigned on a priority basis.
- If there are injuries, take action to establish their extent and administer appropriate first aid.

4.3.3 First Aid

Aim to:

- Preserve life.
- Prevent the condition from worsening.
- Promote recovery - Treat for shock – Reassure and keep warm.

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4.3.4 Communications

Direct contact with a Parent of a group member, from the scene of the incident should be avoided. This task should be carried out by senior staff.

1. Contact the appropriate emergency service(s). They will guide you through the information they need but this will include:
2. Your name and the name of the Group
3. Location
4. Nature of emergency and number of injured persons
5. Action so far
6. Alert the Establishment/Employer's Emergency Contact. You may be in shock and need support. Also, news travels fast and your Establishment/Employer will need accurate information.
7. Consider other people who may need contacting
8. Police
9. Embassy/Consulate if abroad
10. Local accommodation/contact
11. Tour operator/provider
12. Insurer
13. DO NOT speak to the media. Refer all media interest/enquiries to the Establishment/Employer.
14. Control any communications by the rest of the group. Rumours spread very quickly and can cause serious and unnecessary upset.

4.3.5 Secondary Action

1. Arrange appropriate protection from the elements.
2. Uninjured group members should be moved to shelter or away from the immediate vicinity of any casualties.
3. **Ensure that they:**

a. Are adequately supervised throughout

b. Are returned as early as possible to base

c. Receive appropriate support and reassurance.

4. Avoid splitting the group – unless it is the only way to get help – and leave nobody on their own.
5. Manage the incident - ensure that all appropriate actions have been/are being attended to
6. It is useful to keep an accurate record of events and actions as close to real time as possible. Any leader with spare capacity should, therefore, keep notes – see the section below on recording an incident.
7. Ensure that an appropriate adult accompanies any casualties to hospital, taking with them parental consent forms and appropriate medical information for the injured persons.
8. Maintain contact with the emergency services and the Establishment/Employer contact until the Emergency is over.
9. Monitor, reassess and review – ensure nothing has been forgotten and all leaders and young people are coping, cared for and secure.

4.3.6 Post-Incident Action

1. Consider the emotional needs of any leaders or young people who may have been adversely affected.
2. Follow your Employer's and Establishment's reporting requirements, including completing any accident and incident forms and complying with Reporting of Incidents, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrence Regulations.
3. Review the lessons learned and ensure that these feed into future visit plans, emergency plans and staff training.
4. Share the experience and learning with colleagues

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4.3.7 Media/legal points

- Do not admit anything.
- Do not sign anything.
- Avoid discussing legal liability with others.
- Do not talk to the press – refer them to your employer's media contact.
- Record all events, times and details – establish witness contact details and get statements from leaders

4.3.8 Recording an incident

Make an accurate record of all details as soon as possible – do not leave this until later when your memory of details may be confused

4.3.9 Record the following:

- time, date and nature of the incident.
- accurate incident location.
- names of casualties.
- details of injuries.
- actions taken, including all communications.
- names of others involved but not injured.
- details of any moves from the incident site (times, who moved, where to, how).
- names and contact details of witnesses.
- proposed actions.

As soon as is practicable the incident will be reported on the incident report form.

4.3.10 Emergency & Critical Incidents

Serious incidents and accidents are very rare, but they can happen. Minor incidents, accidents or emergencies are more common. We aim to reduce the exposure to these risks through our safety and risk management system. In doing so we believe that our staff and our client's exposure to risk is reduced.

A hierarchy of emergencies

When we consider how things might go wrong, we categorise these emergencies into three separate areas. We like these terms because they sound distinct from one another. We wouldn't want confusion about the severity of the situation when calling out from a poor phone connection; or a case of '*broken telephone*' as the message is passed from one person to another.

Everything's ok

Everything's ok is used when no immediate help is required from resources outside of Adventure Ardeche. There might have been an incident that needs to be communicated about, a request for resources later, an update, etc.

The accident / incident book is completed following the event.

Minor

A **Minor** situation is usually an evacuation of a person off of the trip which requires non-emergency support and transport.

The accident / incident book is completed following the event.

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Emergency

An **Emergency** situation is one that is life or limb threatening and time sensitive. We would request outside help from emergency services such as the police, ambulance, or pompier.

4.3.11 Protocol

- All of our staff will be trained in the Emergency procedure
- All lead instructors will have a charged mobile phone whilst working with clients
- All of our staff will be first aid trained
- Scenario based tests of the emergency procedure and critical incident plan will occur at least once per season.

All staff will have an emergency procedure laminated card with them.

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4.4 Accident & Incident Procedure

ToDo.!

The **Director of Operations** is responsible for the correct application of the procedure.

Occurrences will be classified as:

- **Accident:** Injuries requiring first aid/medical treatment.
- **Major:** Death or requiring overnight hospital admission.
- **Serious:** Involving personal injury requiring professional medical attention.
- **Minor:** Involving minor personal harm.
- **Incident:** Involving the potential to cause harm:
- **Major Incident:** Involving the potential to cause a major accident or significant harm.
- **Other Incident:** Involving the potential to cause harm.

The **Accueils Collectifs de Mineurs Director** will review all reports & additionally will automatically advise all major accidents, accidents that would be reportable in the UK under the Reporting of Incidents, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrence Regulations, to the Managing Director.

All Major Incidents are to be reported to the Managing Director.

The Deputy Director is responsible for ensuring relevant accidents are reported under the Reporting of Incidents, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrence Regulations scheme.

The Director of Operations is responsible for producing a report for any safety review in conjunction with relevant senior staff.

4.4.1 Specific Procedures

All staff and clients will be encouraged to report all accidents and incidents.

In all cases, an Accident/Incident Form will be completed and entered onto the Accident & Incident Database by the Director of Operations.

Forms will be passed to the appropriate member of senior staff to review & action any appropriate measures.

Forms will then be filed in date order for a minimum period of ten years or a time period such as GDPR regulates.

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4.5 Illness Procedure

Do.!

All illnesses will be reported to your Line Manager.

Staff with a suspected infectious disease will be referred to a general practitioner. Control measures will be taken as advised by the general practitioner.

Employees Involved in Food Preparation, Cooking or Service:

- Adventure Ardeche catering staff suffering from any illness will report to the *Catering Manager* immediately.
- Employees suffering from diarrhoea/vomiting or who have infected wounds, sores / skin infections that would come in contact with food, will not be allowed in the vicinity of the food areas.
- If the person can work, they will be given alternative work outside of the food areas.
- Any areas they may have contaminated will then be cleaned and any contaminated food disposed of.
- If after 24 hours the person has recovered and only had one bout of diarrhoea / vomiting they may return to work.
- If after 24 hours the person still has diarrhoea / vomiting they will seek medical advice and continue to be excluded from work.
- If Salmonella typhi, Salmonella paratyphi A, B or C, Escherichia Coli, or Hepatitis A is diagnosed by a general practitioner, Local Environmental Health Service is to be contacted immediately.

4.5.1 Food related illness

In the event of an incidence of at least two cases reporting similar symptoms that could be attributed to a food related cause the following people will be contacted: Departmental Director for Health & Social Services.

Advice given by the local hospitals, a general practitioner or Environmental Health authorities will be followed.

All incidents will be documented.

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4.6 Fire & Flood Evacuation Procedure

Do.!

All staff will be training in the Evacuation Procedure, as outlined below, during their induction training.

Site evacuation will be implemented once the emergency procedure has been initiated.

A location where clients and staff could be evacuated immediately in the event of an emergency will be identified prior to the start of the operating season. This venue should be close to the Base Du Cros and large enough to provide temporary shelter.

Possible secondary evacuation venues will be identified. Secondary evacuation venues will be used if the duration of the emergency requires the provision of catering and accommodation facilities for our clients and staff.

4.6.1 Fire

All Adventure Network staff will be trained and assessed in the Fire Procedure during their induction.

All Adventure Network staff will be trained in the use of fire fighting equipment.

All relevant Adventure Network staff will be trained and assessed in the Control of Substances Hazardous to Health and the use of hazardous chemicals

4.6.2 Risk Controls

The Accueils Collectifs de Mineurs Director is responsible for ensuring that the Fire Procedure is complied with.

Appropriate fire alarm systems will be employed at the Base Du Cros.

Staff will be trained in evacuation systems; including assembly points & roll calls. Clients will be given a fire drill briefing within six hours of arrival at the Centre. This will be recorded in the Fire Book.

Local fire regulations will be adhered to.

Fire doors will be kept closed and free of obstructions at all times. There is a no-smoking policy in all Adventure Network buildings, marquees and accommodation.

Materials that pose a high risk of fire are prohibited outside designated areas. This list includes but is not limited to:

- Candles.
- Gas, oil and fuel burners.
- Electric element heaters.
- Incense sticks.
- Electric blankets.
- BBQs and Camp Fires.
- Portable BBQs are prohibited at the property.
- BBQs are restricted to designated areas only.
- The use of campfires during the high season is limited to lighting for educational purposes and are closely monitored while lit.

4.6.3 Fire through Electrical Faults

Electrical systems will comply with local legislation. A qualified electrician will check all systems annually; this will be recorded in the *Registre De Securite*. Where possible electrical appliances will be portable appliances tested (**PAT**).

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4.6.4 Kitchen Fires

Kitchen areas will comply with local regulations. All kitchens will be equipped with fire blankets. Qualified advice will be followed with regards to appropriate fire fighting equipment for kitchens. Catering staff will be trained in the use of kitchen specific fire fighting equipment.

4.6.5 Fire Risk through Volatile Substances

Volatile substances will be stored securely and in line with Control of Substances Hazardous to Health regulations.

Stores will be ventilated and have controlled access.

All staff using volatile substances will be trained and assessed in the use of hazardous chemicals and Control of Substances Hazardous to Health during their induction.

All volatile substances will be stored according to the Dangerous Substances and Explosive Atmospheres Regulations (**DSEAR.**) These can be found at the following link: Explosive Atmospheres Regulations All senior staff will be made aware of and have access to this information. A copy of this document will be printed and filed in the *Registre De Securite*.

Fire fighting equipment will be serviced at the start of the season; this will be recorded in the *Registre De Securite*.

An independent service will be carried out at the beginning of the season on the fire alarm system, this will be recorded in the *Registre De Securite*.

All fire fighting equipment will be checked on a weekly basis, this will include a visual check of the condition of all extinguishers, fire blankets, fire alarms etc, as well as ensuring all equipment is present and set out in appropriate places.

Any missing or damaged equipment will be reported to the Duty Manager.

Every client will receive a fire drill briefing within 6 hours of arriving on Centre, this briefing will include but is not limited to the following:

- How to raise the alarm.
- Location of fire alarm points and how to find an Adventure Ardeche staff member.
- Instruction in the use of fire alarms.
- Location of fire assembly points.

If a fire is found by a member of Adventure Ardeche staff they will use their own judgement on whether to raise the alarm or tackle the fire.

If the fire is small and there is no immediate threat to clients or staff the fire should be tackled using the appropriate fire fighting equipment.

If the fire is near to staff or client accommodation the fire alarm should always be raised. The fire may then be tackled using the appropriate fire fighting equipment if it is deemed safe to do so.

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If the fire alarm is raised the following procedure will be implemented:

- In the event of the fire alarm being raised the most senior member of staff on duty will collect the Live File, Visitors Book and Staff Rotas from the office. If the source and scale of the fire is known at this stage the fire brigade should be called immediately or an appointed person should tackle the fire accordingly.
- The most senior member of staff will then proceed immediately to the fire/flood assembly point and take on the role of Fire Officer.
- All other available members of staff will direct all clients, off-duty staff and visitors to the fire assembly point.
- On arrival at the fire assembly point the Fire Officer will appoint duty members of staff to search the site for the source of the fire and to ensure that the site is fully evacuated.
- A full roll call will be taken including clients, staff and visitors.
- The Fire Officer will present themselves to the fire brigade with all available information - such as location and scale of fire, any persons unaccounted for, etc - and take direction from them. At this stage the Emergency Procedure will be implemented and depending on the scale of the incident the Site Evacuation Plan may be put into action.

Only the Fire Officer can end the fire alarm. This should be done when either:

- The Fire Officer being assured that the alarm was false.
- The Fire Officer being assured that any fire is extinguished and that there is no further risk.
- The Fire Officer is given the all clear from the fire brigade.

At any appropriate stage a more senior member of staff can take on the role of Fire Officer.

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4.7 Monitoring Procedure

ToDo.!

Monitoring is a fundamental part of our Safety Management System, and as Adventure Ardeche moves to a Safety by Design system. Compliance with policies & risk awareness will be checked as a primary part of the process.

Quality assurance is a secondary, but fundamental, part of the process, with a focus on client care & customer satisfaction.

Monitoring also provides an opportunity for constructive feedback for our staff, enabling them to develop.

The **Accueils Collectifs de Mineurs Director** will approve monitors for all work areas. The Director of Operations will maintain the Monitoring records.

Employees will be individually monitored during their primary work activity on at least 1 occasion every 2 weeks.

Employees will be monitored across a range of work activities.

Individual feedback will be given to employees as part of the monitoring process. Any necessary support or further training requirements will be recorded.

A record of all monitoring to be forwarded to the Director of Operations at the end of each month.

Department heads will, in accordance with their supervisory role, continually monitor employees' work performance informally.

4.7.1 Centre Monitoring

The Director of Operations will carry out a Safety Management Systems Audit of the centre once a year.

The subsequent report will be forwarded to the Board & used in subsequent safety reviews.

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4.8 GDPR Protocol

Do.!

GDPR & Data Protection

Lawfulness, fairness and transparency — Processing must be lawful, fair, and transparent to the data subject.

Purpose limitation — You must process data for the legitimate purposes specified explicitly to the data subject when you collected it.

Data minimisation — You should collect and process only as much data as absolutely necessary for the purposes specified.

Accuracy — You must keep personal data accurate and up to date.

Storage limitation — You may only store personally identifying data for as long as necessary for the specified purpose.

Integrity and confidentiality — Processing must be done in such a way as to ensure appropriate security, integrity, and confidentiality (e.g. by using encryption).

Accountability — The data controller is responsible for being able to demonstrate GDPR compliance with all of these principles.

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4.9 Ensuring Quality

Do.!

This document is in place to ensure that our client's experience is of high quality. It is based on 5 fundamental standards.

- Planning the experience
- Providing accurate information to guests
- Providing adventures which meet the needs of guests
- Reviewing client experiences
- Safety and Risk management

Prior to a client visiting we aim to capture their learning needs; we do this either through pre arrival communication via email or telephone conversation. Where this is not possible, we discuss learning outcomes as part of our welcome meeting with visiting staff. Once captured, this information is then shared with staff working with the group.

4.9.1 Providing accurate information to guests

It is of the utmost importance to us that we provide accurate, honest information to our guests in advance of travel. This includes, the quality and experience of staff, all costs being discussed and agreed in advance of travel and that all activities and accommodation are as agreed.

4.9.2 Providing adventures that meet the needs of guests

We make use of different locations and activities depending on the needs of guests. There are different sections of river that can be used, different crags and different excursion venues. Working with guests in advance of their trip and during, can make sure that we meet their needs.

4.9.3 Reviewing client experiences

Feedback is collected through daily conversations with visiting staff and group leaders. This feedback is reflected upon and working with the **Leadership Team**, changes can be made to the programme and staff coached to ensure learning outcomes are met. In addition to this we ask for feedback from group leaders once they have returned from their trip.

4.9.4 Safety and Risk Management

Safety and risk management is of fundamental importance to us. We have adopted the **Outdoor Education Activity Providers** national guidance for our approach to this area. Our approach can be summarised in the following sentence.

> We ensure the right leaders, do the right activities, with the right people, in the right places at the right time.

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5. Risk Assessments

5.1 Ardeche Descent RA

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5.2 Raft Build RA

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5.3 Stand Up Paddling RA

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5.4 Gorge Trek RA

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5.5 Foss Hill RA

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5.6 Initiatives RA

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5.7 Adventure Challenge RA

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5.8 Ardeche Olympics RA

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6. Activities

6.1 Ardeche Descent

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6.2 Raft Build

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6.3 Stand Up Paddling

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7. Learning

7.1 Learning & Development

7.1.1 Learning Objectives

> **Info**
>
> You should define the knowledge and skill set of your target audience before starting. You can then use this information to avoid wasting time explaining information your audience already knows.

Just as stories are used to define software, learning objectives can be written using a standard template:

As a `user` *of the* `solution` *I* `know a specific piece of information`*, or* `can perform a specific task`*.*

For each learning objective, you should:

Identify what your audience should know and be able to do after they have read the documentation, and/or participated in the activity. Use that information to create a list of **Learning Objectives**.

Clearly worded learning objectives enable you to focus the content on comprehensive and coherent goals. Learning objectives should be evident in the title and content.

If there is no existing documentation set, some areas will be well documented, while others will either be poorly defined or missing. Expect to find duplicate and outdated content. Maintain a list of the best documentation you find for any learning objective.

7.1.2 Tuckmans - Stages of Team Development

Tuckman model is an approach to team development that helps teams understand their current state and develop strategies to move towards their goals. Tuckman (1965) identified four stages of team development, including Forming, Storming, Norming, and Performing, later extended to a Fifth stage - Adjourning.

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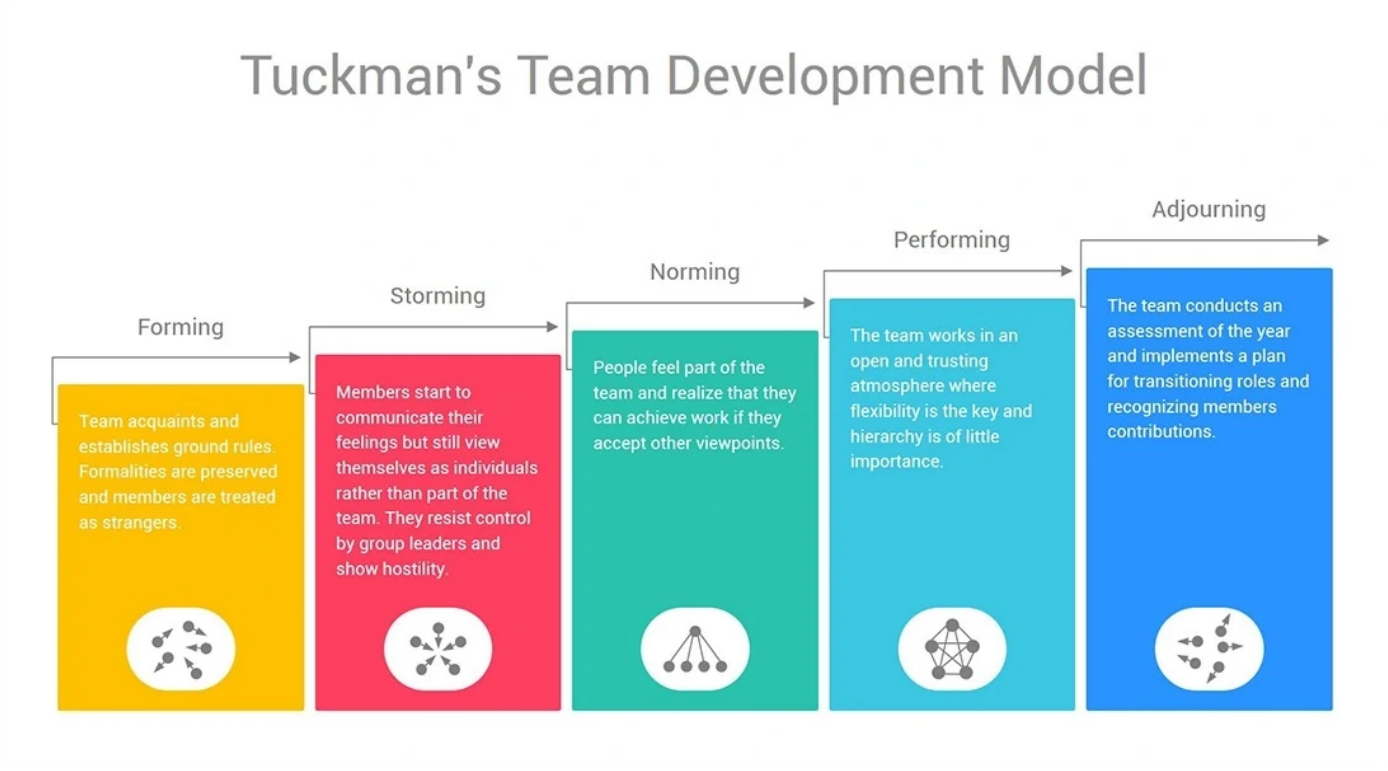

Tuckmans - Stages of Development

Five Stages of The Tuckman Model of Group Development

FORMING

This phase occurs when new members join an existing team or organization. During this period, individuals are still learning about their roles on the team. They try to understand what they need to do to succeed. In most cases, it can take several months before people feel comfortable with one another. It may also take some time before you get your first performance review from someone who knows you well enough to give you feedback.

STORMING

As the name suggests, this is the “storm” part of the process. Members begin to argue among themselves as they figure out where they stand within the team’s hierarchy. They might even start fighting amongst themselves. If left unchecked, this behavior could lead to severe problems down the road if not addressed immediately.

NORMING

Once everyone feels more at ease, the team begins to work together toward common goals. People become familiar with others’ strengths and weaknesses and learn how best to use them. At this point, there should be fewer arguments between teammates because everyone understands their role on the team.

PERFORMING

Finally, once all members have learned how to cooperate effectively, the team performs better than ever before. Everyone works together smoothly and efficiently towards achieving shared objectives. You know you’re ready to move into the next stage when you no longer hear anyone complain about working with other team members.

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ADJOURNING

Once the goal has been achieved, the team recognizes individual contributions and then disbands. This is sometimes called the mourning stage because members feel a sense of loss after separating from those they've shared a meaningful experience with. Any lessons learned from the process should be passed to a responsible person for use by future teams.

Which Factors Affect Team Performance?

The Tuckman model of group development considers three factors that affect team performance. These three factors are;

1. Content refers to what the team does, the actual work that they perform.

2. Process refers to how the team performs the work.

3. Feelings refer to how the team members relate to one another.

When a team focuses on the balance between all three, it can elevate performance.

The following table represents the team attitude on these three factors during each stage of development.

Stages	Content	Process	Feelings
Forming	The team attempts to define the work the team needs to do.	The team might seek external guidance to define how to do the work	Team members are unsure and may need a leader to guide them
Storming	Team members may resist the task demands	Member may attempt to avoid doing the work and find reasons to do so	Friction about individual positions & hierarchy of the team
Norming	The team starts to open up about the work and challenges	Processes start getting defined and adopted	Members become collaborative and start working collectively
Performing	The team meets work challenges and delivers	Processes ensure systematic allocation of resources and systematic workflow	Members share common objectives and become accountable
Adjouring	In the adjourning phase, the **Leadership** acknowledges the efforts of the team and, in the process, brings about closure.	Before this occurs, however, the team is assembled one final time and individuals are encouraged to share their experiences of working at the organisation.	It's important that the team does not gloss over any of the problems encountered or lessons learned. This is because the solutions and insights are valuable to subsequent teams who may find themselves in similar predicaments.

Summary

Abstract

The Tuckman model for team development is an excellent tool for helping teams understand their dynamics and how they interact with each other. It is one of the most widely used models for explaining group behavior. Understanding the Tuckman model helps us develop better teams and ensure effective value delivery.

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7.2 Shaping the AA Programme

Question

What can we focus on in regards participant learning during the Adventure Ardeche experience?

The following skills are essential for young people to be able to grow into for their futures.

7.2.1 PROBLEM-SOLVING

When young people solve problems independently, they will be happier, more confident and more independent; they will not feel frustrated or disheartened by their inefficiency.

Outdoor learning experiences allow students of all ages to experience risk and adventure at a developmentally appropriate pace. Students experience hands-on learning and engage in authentic problem-solving in ways they cannot experience with the same depth in traditional settings. Outdoor learning experiences provide immediate feedback, meaning students can quickly identify mistakes, make changes and discover how failures can lead to new understandings.

7.2.2 COMMUNICATION

Communication skills are among the most crucial skills for students in today's world. At all levels of education and beyond, students must be able to communicate effectively.

Adventure Ardeche programmes provide outcomes focusing on verbal, non-verbal and visual communication, active listening, emotional control, adaptability and interpersonal skills.

Through outdoor activities, young people exercise their active listening and adaptive communication skills.

7.2.3 TEAMWORK

Unsurprisingly, getting along and engaging with others is vital for many things in life; it is a core social skill. Young people need to learn how to give and take, share, take turns, play to their strengths and draw in others.

Adventure Ardeche programmes heighten skills in communication, conflict resolution, rapport-building, persuasion, and organisational and planning outcomes.

Outdoor education provides rich personal and social development opportunities through carefully structured group activities in challenging situations. Working together in the classroom looks very different from, say, building a raft. In this environment, students quickly understand their success means the success of their group and become far more aware of how to support those around them.

7.2.4 COMMUNITY AND SOCIAL CONNECTION

Social connection is critical to physical and mental wellbeing in people of all ages, it brings a feeling of being accepted and appreciated for their best qualities.

Adventure Ardeche programmes deliver outcomes of social responsibility, compassion, relationship management, cooperation, flexibility, self-belief, respect and communal living.

Sharing a new and exciting adventure in the outdoors enhances friendship and camaraderie among students.

7.2.5 ACCEPTING CHALLENGE

As they grow, young people encounter increasing stresses and obstacles. To thrive, young people must develop strengths, acquire skills to cope, recover from hardships, and be prepared for future challenges; they need to be resilient.

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In accepting challenges and stepping outside their comfort zones, students develop resilience and coping strategies, equipping them with the skills needed to confront the obstacles they are bound to face in life. Through the Asventure Ardeche experience, students are permitted to constructively explore and ask questions in an encouraging environment, supported by experienced staff.

7.2.6 LEADERSHIP

Students need to experience leadership opportunities during their schooling and learn the art of building relationships within teams. Leadership skills allow young people to understand they have the ability to make things happen. Exercising leadership skills instils confidence and helps young people solve problems creatively and work collaboratively with others.

Leadership is something young people develop through their experiences. Outdoor education programmes enhance student leadership and allow them to practice and hone their skills in a supportive learning environment. Through varied group activities, each student is provided with a chance to shine and explore just what leadership means to them. Students begin to understand their strengths, learn the value of persevering, remain calm under pressure and know when to ask for help.

7.2.7 PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY

When students take on responsibility, they readily accept the outcome of their choices without holding anybody else accountable by reflecting on their beliefs, ideas, goals, mistakes and achievements. Responsibility requires young people to explore a response proportional to a problem, adapting to obstacles as they arise.

Time at Adventure Ardeche aims to enhance resilience, self-worth, decision-making, honesty, respect, a sense of fairness, accountability, and courage.

Outdoor education offers unique opportunities for increased responsibility young people may not have elsewhere in their lives and carry with them inherent feelings of maturity and self-belief. On programme, young people can make decisions for themselves in unfamiliar environments and face new consequences and rewards, for example, what to wear, what to eat, and how they contribute to their group. Naturally, young people will learn and grow from their successes and mistakes and become more confident in tackling future obstacles.

7.2.8 EMPATHY

Empathy is a powerful tool; it is a key element of emotional intelligence, linking oneself and others. Those who have empathy better understand the perspectives, needs, and intentions of others and can work through difficult moments from a position of strength. Empathetic students are more cooperative, have better relationships and are more engaged.

When students are tired, sore, and uncomfortable, the lessons learnt often teach them more about personal strength and empathy than any classroom or textbook. After a day of adventure, we encourage reflection. Students listen to and share their experiences of the day, allowing them to hear their peers' perspectives on it and compare them with their own.

7.2.9 ENVIRONMENTAL CONNECTION

Connecting young people to the natural world is more vital than ever. Environmental literacy allows young people to understand how their actions affect the environment, builds the knowledge necessary to address complex ecological issues, and imparts practical ways to keep our environment flourishing for the future.

Adventure Ardeche aim to enhance outcomes around environmental literacy and sustainable practices, creativity, innovative and critical thinking, foresight, negotiation, collaboration, community projects and an investigative mind.

To prepare our young people for a complex world, they need environmental connection as a foundation upon which to make choices for their future. Connecting young people to the natural world prepares them for citizenship and encourages them to share their voices and make a positive difference.

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7.2.10 BUILDING TRUST

Trust allows young people to feel part of a relationship or group, with a shared purpose and a willingness to depend on each other – this is vital in the classroom and in a work environment. Students who trust those around them will display more positive behaviour and take on more responsibility.

Learning to trust and how to navigate social interactions takes practice. Our programmes provide young people with endless opportunities to exercise and build trust – not only in their peers but in themselves too. Reading a map setting off sown the river can feel overwhelming. However, during our programmes, students understand they can lean on their peers for help; they are encouraged to recognise and trust their peers' abilities and support one another.

7.2.11 WELLBEING

Wellbeing is a multi-faceted concept involving much more than just physical health. It's a combination of a person's emotional, mental and social health and it also reflects how they feel about themselves and their life in general. Overall, wellbeing enhances motivation, decreases disciplinary problems, increases academic achievement and improves satisfaction.

The physical and mental health benefits of simply being in the natural world are increasingly understood and accepted by governments locally and around the world. Exposing young people to natural environments reduces stress and increases wellbeing. Outdoor education is key to supporting young peoples' mental health.

7.2.12 POSITIVE EDUCATION AND MINDFULNESS

Positive education has been defined as "education for both traditional skills and for happiness;" strengthening traditional skills while also fostering positive character strength and enhancing student wellbeing and happiness.

Through positive education and mindfulness, students have fewer potential obstacles standing in the way of their progress.

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7.3 Focus Words

7.3.1 A list of words to create discussion, action, and/or focus

Note

These words could be used amongst ourselves as a staff team as much as with our guests. Consider that what we say, what we do, our actions in general have a bearing on self, others and our environment.

- **How do those actions impact?**
- **What are the consequences?**

Analytical Skills

Innovative and Critical Thinking

Lateral mindset

Adaptability and Flexibility

Initiative

Decision-making and Time-management

Verbal, non-Verbal and Visual Communication

Active Listening

Emotional Control

Interpersonal skills

Conflict resolution

Rapport-building

Persuasion, Organisation and Planning

Social Responsibility

Relationship Management

Cooperation

Self-belief

Communal Living

Independence

Self-awareness

Social Influence

Fellowship

Self and Social Management

Confidence

Goal setting

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Resilience

Self-worth

Honesty

Respect

A Sense of Fairness

Accountability

Courage

Compassion

Positive Social Growth

Curiosity

Social and Emotional Awareness

Environmental Literacy

Sustainable Practices

Creativity

Foresight

Negotiation

Collaboration

Community

Investigative Mind

Social Cohesion

Social Security

Acceptance and Accountability

Physical and Mental well-being and health

Positive attitudes

Active contribution

Focus and a sense of identity

Growth mindset

Character strengths

Gratitude

Engagement

Automaticity

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8. Resources

8.1 Resources

8.1.1 Risk Assessment

Risk Benefit Worksheet

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9. Personal Adventure

9.1 Still to write

Still To Write

This document is **Still to Write**

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https://github.com/Matt-Adventure-Ardeche/staffhandbook

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